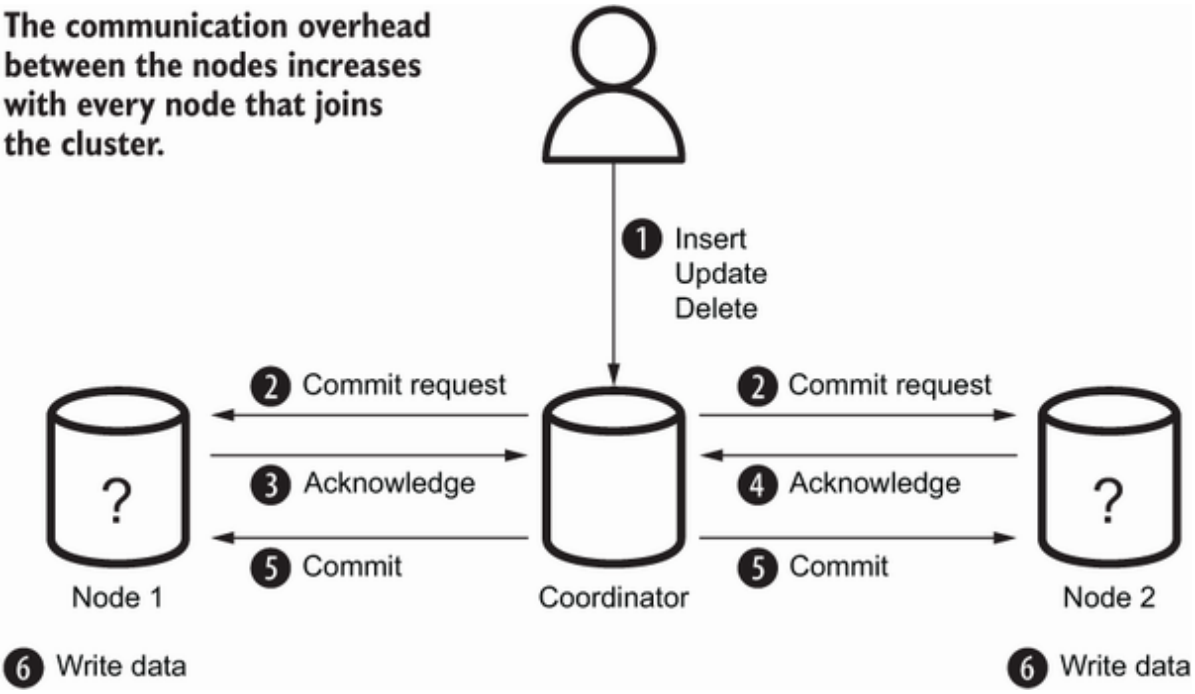


Figure 12.1 The communication overhead between the nodes increases with every node that joins the cluster.

The problem is, the more nodes you add, the slower your database becomes, because more nodes must coordinate transactions between each other. The way to tackle this has been to use databases that don't adhere to these guarantees. They're called *NoSQL databases*.

There are four types of NoSQL databases—document, graph, columnar, and key-value store—each with its own uses and applications. Amazon provides a NoSQL database service called *DynamoDB*, a key-value store. DynamoDB is a fully managed, proprietary, closed source key-value store with document support. In other words, DynamoDB persists objects identified by a unique key, which you might know from the concept of a hash table. *Fully managed* means that you only use the service and AWS operates it for you. DynamoDB is highly available and highly durable. You can